

FIVE MOVES

that keep a conversation alive

PARAPHRASE

Say their idea back in your own words.

“So you're saying _____...”

CLARIFY

Ask questions until the idea comes into focus.

“Can you say more about _____...”

BUILD

Add to a partner's idea so it grows.

“I want to build on what _____ said...”

EVIDENCE

Back the idea with something you can point to.

“The text shows this when it says _____...”

CHALLENGE

Push on the idea. Never on the person.

“I see it differently because _____...”

Use all five — then land it. That last move is synthesize.

PARAPHRASE

Say their idea back in your own words.

USE IT WHEN

You need to be sure you heard the idea right.

SAY IT LIKE THIS

- So you're saying _____.
- In other words, _____. Did I get that right?
- Your main point is _____.
- So you think _____ because _____.
- What I hear you saying is _____.

SOUNDS LIKE THIS IN CLASS

So you're saying the Constitution protected slavery without ever printing the word. Did I get that right?

CLARIFY

Ask questions until the idea comes into focus.

USE IT WHEN

An idea is fuzzy, too big, or only half-said.

SAY IT LIKE THIS

- Can you say more about _____?
- What do you mean by _____?
- Can you give an example of _____?
- How does _____ connect to _____?
- What makes you say that?

SOUNDS LIKE THIS IN CLASS

You called the Revolution radical. What do you mean by radical – and radical for whom?

BUILD

Add to a partner's idea so it grows.

USE IT WHEN

A partner's idea is going somewhere. Take it further.

SAY IT LIKE THIS

Pairs with CHALLENGE • 05

- I want to build on what _____ said.
- Adding to that, _____.
- That connects to _____ because _____.
- If that's true, then _____.
- Another example of that is _____.

SOUNDS LIKE THIS IN CLASS

Building on that – if the government kept promising land it did not control, then the treaties were written to be broken.

EVIDENCE

Back the idea with something you can point to.

USE IT WHEN

You have made a claim. Every claim needs a receipt.

SAY IT LIKE THIS

- The text shows this when it says _____.
- One example from history is _____.
- According to _____, _____.
- That shows _____ because _____.
- This matters because _____.

SOUNDS LIKE THIS IN CLASS

Document C says the mill hired girls as young as ten, which shows the opportunity Lowell advertised ran on the cheapest labor it could find.

CHALLENGE

Push on the idea. Never on the person.

USE IT WHEN

You see it differently, or the evidence is thin.

SAY IT LIKE THIS

Pairs with BUILD • 03

- I see it differently because _____.
- That's true, but what about _____?
- Have you considered _____?
- What evidence supports that?
- Another way to look at it is _____.

SOUNDS LIKE THIS IN CLASS

I see it differently. Jefferson wrote that all men are created equal and enslaved more than six hundred people. So what did he mean by men?

SYNTHESIZE

Pull the whole conversation into one idea.

USE IT AT THE END

The talk is winding down. Land it somewhere.

SAY IT LIKE THIS

- The big idea we landed on is _____.
- We agreed that _____.
- We disagreed about _____, but _____.
- Our conversation showed _____.
- So overall, _____.

SOUNDS LIKE THIS IN CLASS

We disagreed about whether the Constitution was proslavery, but we both landed here: the men who wrote it chose not to settle the question.